

THE FIRST DECISION

Puri heritage-walk business starter

A practical guide for investigating one local service business.



Start with a question

Would visitors already staying in Puri pay for a well-researched, locally guided outdoor walk? This notebook turns that question into an offer, an evidence checklist and a financial test.

What this edition establishes

A desk-researched opportunity, with named leads and documented permission boundaries. Customer prices, paid demand, exact route, local approvals and business costs remain unknown.

INSIDE

02 Define the service

03 Resolve permissions

04 Find people and premises

05 Test demand

06 Complete the money worksheet

07 Decide and sequence actions

08-09 Inspect the evidence

Use on screen or print. Fillable boxes start on page 2. Save your completed copy privately; personal inputs do not belong in the public repository.

01 / DEFINE

One offer. One clear scope.

Planning choices below are proposals, not a service already operating.

Customer and channel

Start by investigating visitors already staying in Puri. Compare direct bookings with referrals from a consenting hotel or operator. No channel agreement or customer test has been completed.

What the customer would buy

A pre-booked outdoor walk explaining public streets, architecture and cultural history. A named guide, checked script, clear meeting instructions and transparent inclusions would make the offer specific.

Keep the initial scope manageable

Do not promise temple entry, ritual services, transport, food sales or workshop access. Each extension requires its own permissions, hosts and cost evidence. Even an outdoor route needs access and assembly checks.

Proposed route and meeting point

Guide language(s)

Proposed duration

Maximum party size to investigate

Proposed booking / referral channel

The route, timing and capacity are still unverified. Check walking surfaces, toilets, rest points, crowding, weather alternatives and an honest accessibility description with local participants.

02 / PERMISSIONS

Four separate questions

A training certificate, a business recognition and permission to enter a site serve different purposes.

1. Municipal business classification

Describe the exact activity and premises to the relevant authority. Confirm the trade category, required documents, current charges and approval stages. The saved Puri tariff does not establish a payable heritage-walk fee. [1-3]

2. Odisha tourism-business recognition

The state portal provides account registration; it does not prove recognition. An RTI index points to an older instrument whose original text and amendments remain unresolved. [4-5]

3. National business recognition

The 2020 Ministry instrument describes a voluntary startup route. Its criteria include paid-up capital of INR 100,000 for the rest-of-India category, with a stated trust exemption, and at least two qualified staff. These are recognition criteria, not a universal business startup budget. [6]

4. Individual guide and selected stops

Verify the guide's credential category, issuer and validity, then check each stop and private host separately. IITF/IITG training stages do not themselves grant temple entry or local operating permission. [7-8]

What “no office-space requirement” actually means

The national startup column still requires compliance with local government rules. Its recognition runs for three years before transition to another category. Current amendments and applicability to this proposed business remain to be confirmed. [6]

Decision gate: do not sell or deliver a paid trial until the applicable requirements, site permissions and customer terms have been resolved. The source appendix records editions and outstanding retrieval gaps.

03 / PEOPLE AND PREMISES

Build the local working network

Published leads are starting points for a later authorized enquiry. No agreement, endorsement or availability is implied.

Sanatan Sahoo: an advertised Puri walk

A provider page describes a private half-day walk with sahi, akhada and matha themes. The price is on request. Credential claims, group basis, inclusions and permissions have not been independently verified. [9]

Reuse the existing Puri directory research

Debasis Sethi appears in the alternate tourism guide directory. Heritage Tours and Grass Routes appear in operator records with historical approval dates. Confirm present credentials, languages, dates, rates and willingness to work together. [11-12]

Ask for evidence, not just a headline price

Request a written quote: service and party size; preparation and delivery time; language; travel; cancellation; payment; validity; and any exclusions. For a referral channel, agree commission and responsibility for customer refunds.

Premises: compare arrangements before a lease

Investigate a lawful home-office arrangement or a consented meeting/referral point at an existing business. No property has been identified as available or approved. Check exact location, right to use it, permitted activity, access, utilities, hazards and any rent or deposit.

Lead to investigate and role

Premises option and next evidence needed

Use public professional channels. Obtain consent before involving hosts or recording interviews. Keep private contact details and negotiated terms in your private working copy.

04 / DEMAND

Test the offer before committing

A suggested research sequence. None of these interviews, booking tests or paid departures has taken place.

A. Listen to the intended customer

With consent, ask visitors and potential referral partners what they would choose instead, which language they need, what prevents booking and what a clearly described walk is worth to them. Record the date, segment and number approached.

B. Make the proposed offer comparable

Write one route outline with duration, group basis, inclusions, exclusions, meeting conditions and cancellation terms. Separate a customer's stated willingness to pay from a price actually accepted.

C. Resolve delivery before taking payment

Confirm permissions, guide availability, host consent where relevant and a route inspection. Only then consider a small paid trial with explicit customer terms and a clear refund process.

D. Keep a complete trial record

For each date record enquiries, offers made, bookings, deposits, completed departures, party size, price paid, refunds, cancellations and refusals. Keep free participation separate from paid demand.

E. Test a weak period too

A busy festival or a seller's "All Year" label cannot supply a monthly sales forecast. Record low or zero activity, access constraints and cancellation causes. Do not extrapolate one peak period to a full year.

One hypothesis to test first

Use an anonymized tally or consented records; do not add identifiable customer details to Utkal's public research. Website offers establish a marketed category, not sales volumes. [9-10]

05 / MONEY WORKSHEET

Will one departure contribute?

All fields are blank. Currency: INR. Chosen unit: one private-party departure. Manual calculations; no automatic totals.

Price / quote date

Scenario and month

A. Net revenue per departure

B. Variable cost per departure

C. Contribution: A minus B

D. Paid departures in month

E. Monthly fixed costs

F. Operating result: C x D minus E

Break-even departures: E / C, round up

One-time setup outlay

Opening cash after setup

Required minimum cash buffer

Define the inputs consistently

A: revenue retained per departure after refunds and taxes collected for remittance. B: guide delivery pay, travel and other costs that vary with a departure, including booking/referral charges. E: recurring fixed costs, including a realistic owner-pay allowance where appropriate. Avoid counting a cost twice.

If C is zero or negative, there is no finite operating break-even under these assumptions. Compare the rounded-up result with deliverable capacity. F excludes one-time setup, finance costs, debt repayments and any tax not already included. It is not take-home profit or a full cash-flow forecast.

Quote / assumption references and unresolved costs

Repeat the worksheet for a downside month. Build a separate month-by-month cash record including deposits, refunds, payment timing, loans and taxes before assessing funding. No financial viability has been established.

06 / DECIDE

Proceed, revise or stop?

Decide from the evidence you collect. The suggested gates below are an investigation framework, not completed approvals.

Demand

Can you show paid demand for this defined offer? Keep refusals and cancellations visible. Revise the customer, language, channel or price if the evidence does not support them.

Delivery and permission

Can the guide and route deliver what was sold, with current credentials and applicable approvals resolved? If not, pause that offer until the gap is closed.

Contribution and cash

Does the downside case cover recurring costs within realistic capacity, while keeping enough cash for refunds and obligations? Revise costs or scope if it fails; stop if the conditions cannot be met.

Current decision and evidence behind it

YOUR NEXT THREE ACTIONS

1. Action / owner / target date / evidence needed

2. Action / owner / target date / evidence needed

3. Action / owner / target date / evidence needed

Next review date and unresolved blocker

Complete your copy privately. The shared blank template can improve as public evidence changes; personal budgets, IDs, applications and negotiation notes stay outside the public repository.

07 / EVIDENCE

Permissions: follow the originals

Compiled 3 October 2026 from saved source records. This export performs no fresh legal verification. Original editions and unresolved applicability remain visible.

1 SUJOG trade tariff

Puri row: compound airline-travel-agency label; raw rate 2000. Currency, charge period, effective date and fit with this activity remain unresolved. No payable fee adopted.

PDF p623; od.puri; permanent new / renewal rows.

[Open original publisher](#) | enterprise-sujog-tariff

2 SUJOG required documents

Identity and premises/ownership proof are categories with alternatives, not an instruction to submit every listed item.

One-page document table; publication date not established.

[Open original publisher](#) | enterprise-sujog-documents

3 SUJOG citizen manual

Trade details affect calculation; provisional and final certificates are distinct. The saved manual is a historical interface description.

Version 1.1, second draft, 21 June 2023; PDF pp2, 9-17.

[Open original publisher](#) | enterprise-sujog-manual

4 Odisha Tourism registration form

An account-registration route was recovered. No application, recognition, eligibility decision or approval occurred.

Travel-agent registration page; undated.

[Open original publisher](#) | enterprise-odisha-agent-registration

5 Tourism RTI index: unresolved lead

Indexed reference to Resolution 603/TSM, 16 January 2001. Original instrument and full manual unavailable; not adopted as current law.

Indexed Manual 5, row 6; original recovery scheduled for 10 October 2026.

[Open original publisher](#) | enterprise-odisha-recognition-rti-lead

Known retrieval gap: the live SUJOG trade-licence route returned 404 in the saved check. The historical manual and tariff remain available evidence within their stated scope.

08 / EVIDENCE AND EDITION

Training, providers and updates

Source numbers connect the practical pages to the research record. Multiple records from one publication are not independent corroboration.

6 Ministry: tourism-service recognition

Memo: 8 December 2020; operation from 1 January 2021. Startup criteria, local-rule boundary, three-year term and voluntary scheme. Current amendments/applicability unresolved.

PDF pp4-5, 8, 10-12; sections 7, 12, 16(ii)/(vi).

[Open original publisher](#) | enterprise-national-recognition2020

7-8 IITF/IITG certification materials

Booklet distinguishes Basic facilitation from IITG guiding and separates course completion from certification. FAQ process details differ; confirm the current intake.

Booklet: 11 January 2021 with 8 April 2022 modification; PDF pp2-4, 6-7.

[Open original publisher](#) | enterprise-iitf-booklet

9 Sanatan Sahoo: advertised Puri walk

Puri-specific private half-day offer; price on request. Self-described credentials, season and difficulty are not independently verified.

Provider page; undated; no quote or contact requested.

[Open original publisher](#) | enterprise-puri-sanatan-walk

10 I Love Jagannath: advertised walks

Puri appears in its marketed destinations. The header duration and season name Bhubaneswar; they are not used as Puri evidence.

Heritage-walk page; undated; no visible Puri tariff.

[Open original publisher](#) | enterprise-puri-walk-offer

8 IITFC FAQ - Undated; fee and completion questions. Not an all-in startup cost.

11 [Tourism guide directory](#) - Puri / Debasis Sethi; current credentials and availability unknown.

12 [Tourism operator directory](#) - Puri entries; historical dates do not prove current recognition.

EDITION RECORD / OPP-PUR-001

v0.1 - 3 October 2026. Derived from the Puri desk dossier (RES-066). No human review, interviews, local inspection, approvals or financial projections are claimed. Check the latest dossier before relying on this edition.

[Open the maintained research dossier in the review branch](#)

Research status: desk_researched. Website publication: not included in this edition.